

Daily Content Intel

July 16, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, there's a meta-analysis in PLoS One, 34 randomized trials, 990 adolescent soccer players, and it asked a pretty simple question: if you bolt jumping onto normal practice, do athletes actually get faster?

They do. Sprint times improved at every distance they measured, and the effect was biggest over the first 10 meters, which is the piece that actually shows up in football and lacrosse, because you're rarely running 40 yards clean, you're winning the first two steps.

The mechanism is ground contact. Speed comes from how hard you put force into the floor and how fast you get

back off of it, and plyometrics sand that down to short, stiff contacts. Practice makes you tired. Jumping makes you fast.

And the dose is small, probably smaller than you'd think. Twice a week, about 7 weeks, moderate intensity, roughly 1,400 total contacts across the whole block. That's it.

So Monday, before the lift, before practice: 3 sets of 5 pogo hops, 3 sets of 3 broad jumps, full rest between sets, land quiet. Quality every rep. If your athlete is grinding out 200 sloppy jumps at the end of a session when they're already smoked, that's conditioning, and it won't make them faster.

Does that make sense?

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your athlete runs sprints at every practice and still isn't getting faster.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, there's a meta-analysis in PLoS One, 34 randomized trials, 990 adolescent soccer players, and it asked a pretty simple question: if you bolt jumping onto normal practice, do athletes actually get faster?

They do. Sprint times improved at every distance they measured, and the effect was biggest over the first 10 meters, which is the piece that actually shows up in football and lacrosse, because you're rarely running 40 yards clean, you're winning the first two steps.

The mechanism is ground contact. Speed comes from how hard you put force into the floor and how fast you get back off of it, and plyometrics sand that down to short, stiff contacts. Practice makes you tired. Jumping makes you fast.

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Does that make sense?

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 34 studies. 990 athletes. One question.
- 0:08 Do jumps make you faster?
- 0:15 Yes. Biggest effect: first 10 meters.
- 0:28 Speed = force into the ground
- 0:40 The dose: 2x/week, 7 weeks
- 0:52 Monday: 3x5 pogos, 3x3 broad jumps
- 1:05 Land quiet. Full rest. Fresh legs.
- 1:15 It's time to cross your threshold.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Sprinting more doesn't make you a sprinter.

A meta-analysis of 34 randomized trials and 990 adolescent soccer players found that adding plyometrics to normal practice improved sprint times at every distance measured, with the biggest effect over the first 10 meters. That's the range where football and lacrosse are actually played.

Speed comes from how much force you put into the ground and how fast you get off of it. Jumping trains that. Practice just accumulates fatigue.

The dose is small. Twice a week, about 7 weeks, moderate intensity, done fresh.

Do them before the lift, not after. 3 sets of 5 pogo hops, 3 sets of 3 broad jumps, full rest, land quiet. If they're sloppy and tired, you're conditioning, and you've stopped building speed.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#speedtraining #plyometrics #footballtraining
#lacrosse #highschoolfootball
#strengthandconditioning #youthathlete

#athleticdevelopment #sportsPT
#returntosport

Personalize this

- Where do plyos actually sit in the HS football blocks you write, before the lift or on a separate day, and how many contacts do you let a lineman take versus a skill kid in a week?
- Name a specific athlete whose first 10 meters changed once you pulled volume out and put pogos and broad jumps in front of the session. What did the coach notice on film before you told them anything?
- What do you do with the club lacrosse kid who's already playing 4 games a weekend, where do the jumps go when there's no room in the week and everything is already high-impact?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12040276/> | "Effects of plyometric training on jump, sprint, and change of direction performance in adolescent

soccer player: A systematic review with meta-analysis"

- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12040276/> | "plyometric training significantly improved sprinting ability compared with regular soccer training, with a small but positive overall effect size (SMD = -0.45, 95%CI: [-0.57, -0.32], $p < 0.001$)"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12040276/> | "twice-weekly, 7-week, 1,400-repetition moderate-intensity plyometric training is sufficient to cause a significant enhancement in COD abilities"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12040276/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12104980/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, this one bothers me, and I want to be careful with how I say it.

204 young athletes, all of them post ACL reconstruction, all of them finished a return to sport bridge program, all of them cleared and released back to their sport around 8 and a half months out. Researchers then followed them for almost 8 years.

17 tore an ACL again, either the graft or the other knee. And when they looked at who those athletes were, the ones who got hurt had scored higher on their knee function questionnaires coming out of the program. They felt better about their knee than everybody else did.

Now, it's an association inside a small number of injuries, so I'm hedging here.

But it lines up with what I see in the clinic. Confidence is not a clearance criterion. Feeling ready and being ready are two separate measurements, and only one of them shows up on a test.

So here's my hot take. A lot of return to sport programs are quietly measuring whether the athlete believes they're back. I want strength symmetry side to side, I want hop testing, I want change of direction under fatigue, and I want to watch them move at the end of a session when they're tired and they've stopped thinking about their knee.

The kid who tells me he feels 100% at 8 months? That's the kid I test hardest.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The athletes who felt the best about their knee are the ones who tore it again.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, this one bothers me, and I want to be careful with how I say it.

204 young athletes, all of them post ACL reconstruction, all of them finished a return to sport bridge program, all of them cleared and released back to their sport around 8 and a half months out. Researchers then followed them for almost 8 years.

17 tore an ACL again, either the graft or the other knee. And when they looked at who those athletes were, the ones who got hurt had scored higher on their knee function questionnaires coming out of the program. They felt better about their knee than everybody else did.

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So here's my hot take. A lot of return to sport programs are quietly measuring whether the athlete believes they're back. I want strength

symmetry side to side, I want hop testing, I want change of direction under fatigue, and I want to watch them move at the end of a session when they're tired and they've stopped thinking about their knee.

The kid who tells me he feels 100% at 8 months? That's the kid I test hardest.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 204 athletes. 8 years. One pattern.
- 0:10 All cleared to return at ~8 months
- 0:20 17 tore an ACL again
- 0:30 The reinjured group scored HIGHER on knee function
- 0:42 Confidence is not a clearance criterion
- 0:55 Strength symmetry. Hop testing. COD under fatigue.
- 1:08 "I feel 100%" = test harder
- 1:18 It's time to cross your threshold.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Feeling ready and being ready are two different measurements.

204 young athletes, all post ACL reconstruction, all cleared out of a return to sport bridge program around 8 and a half months. Followed for almost 8 years. 17 tore an ACL again, graft or the opposite knee. The athletes who got hurt had scored higher on their knee function questionnaires on the way out.

It's an association in a small number of injuries, so hold it loosely. But it matches what I see. Confidence is not a clearance criterion.

Across the wider literature, roughly 1 in 5 athletes under 20 reinjure a knee after ACL reconstruction. No testing battery is going to erase all of that. It can stop a good mood from counting as a passing grade.

Strength symmetry side to side. Hop testing. Change of direction under fatigue. Movement quality when they're tired and no longer thinking about the knee.

The athlete who tells me he feels 100% at 8 months is the one I test hardest.

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Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT

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#ACL #returntosport #aclrehab #sportsPT
#highschoolfootball #lacrosse #youthathlete
#kneerehab #athletictraining
#strengthandconditioning

Personalize this

- Tell the story of a specific return-to-sport call you made where the athlete's confidence was way ahead of their testing. What did you hold them back on, and how did that conversation with the athlete and the parent actually go?
- What's on your own clearance checklist beyond symmetry and hop testing, and what's the number or the moment that makes you say "not yet" even when the kid feels great?
- Where does this land in CROSS, and how do you explain to a football or lacrosse parent that 8 months on the calendar isn't

the criterion when the whole season is sitting there in front of them?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12452617/> | "Young Athletes Perceiving Greater Improvement After Return to Sport Bridge Program Sustained More Ipsilateral ACL Graft or Contralateral ACL Injuries During Their First Season Back: An Observational Study"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12452617/> | "Athletes who sustained ipsilateral ACL graft or contralateral ACL injury were younger, and more often scored $\geq$ 25th percentile for post-program global sports activities knee function and KOS-SAS scores."
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12452617/> | "Factors other than physical function or performance capability may possess a strong influence on ipsilateral ACL graft or contralateral ACL injury following RTS bridge program participation."

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12452617/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7785893/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Resisted vs unresisted sprint training in youth footballers (sled at 20% body mass, 44 players): NCT07418892, trial posted Feb 2026, worth watching for results.
- Combined functional + traditional training beat either alone in adolescent sprinters (-4.71% sprint time vs -3.65% and -2.18%), Frontiers in Public Health. Could stand on its own as a "stop picking one method" Reel.
- Mike T. Nelson's metabolism episode (Stronger Podcast, Don Saladino): solid myth-busting on "stoking your metabolism," needs an athlete recast before it earns a slot.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (2026-07-16): only 2 sources, both thin. Mercola = pure teaser copy, no finding. Mike T. Nelson = "Is your metabolism broken?" podcast promo (Stronger Podcast w/ Don Saladino). Good general-pop myth material, weak

athlete fit, and miketnelson.com was already cited 2026-07-08. Skipped both.

- PubMed / PMC: swept adolescent sprint & speed development, plyometrics, resisted sprinting, ACL return-to-sport, hamstring rehab, youth resistance training. Strong hits on plyometrics-for-speed and RTS psychological readiness.
- PLoS One: plyometric meta-analysis in adolescent soccer players (34 RCTs, 990 athletes). Picked for Draft A.
- Journal of Functional Morphology and Kinesiology: RTS bridge program observational study, 204 athletes, ~8-year follow-up. Picked for Draft B.
- Frontiers in Public Health: adolescent sprinter functional/traditional/combined RCT (52 athletes, 15-18). Used as support for Draft A.
- Sports Health: 1-in-5 reinjury systematic review (1,239 athletes under 20). Used as support for Draft B.
- Rejected on dedup: cold water immersion / hypertrophy meta (PMC11235606, cited 2026-05-27). Rejected on topic recency:

massage gun warm-up study (topic family cited 2026-07-06, 10 days out, too soon to repeat).

- NSCA blog, BJSM, JOSPT, Pacey Performance, Just Fly, Iron Culture, r/AdvancedFitness: nothing in the last 7 days beating the two picks above.